UNIT 3

Basic Concepts of Political Science

Part I



3.1 SOVEREIGNTY

Introduction

3.1.1 Let us discuss about Sovereignty

Sovereignty, the term has been derived from the Latin word 'superanus' which means 'supreme' or 'paramount'. Roman jurist and the civilians during the middle ages employed the term 'summa potestas' and 'Plenitude potestas' to designate the supreme power of the state. In political science the use of the term 'sovereignty' dates back to the publication of ***Bodin's*** 'The Republic' in 1576.

The stability of a nation depends on the supremacy of the sovereignty the nation enjoys. Sovereignty as a concept represents the legal supremacy of the state. Constitution lays down rules and laws of the state and the constitution of the state is just the representation of the sovereignty. The word sovereign in the preamble of the constitution of India means that the state has the power to legislate on any subjects in conformity with constitutional limitations.

3.1.2. Characteristics of Sovereignty.

1. Permanence

The chief characteristic of sovereignty is permanence. Sovereignty lasts as long as the state lasts. The death of the king or the overthrow of the government does not affect sovereignty. Hence, the people of England say 'King is dead, Long live the king'.

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Learning Objectives

- The meaning and characteristics of Sovereignty
- The aspects and kinds of Sovereignty
- Meaning and dawn of Pluralism

2. Exclusiveness

Exclusiveness here implies that there cannot be two sovereign in one independent state and if it exists the unity of the state will be destroyed.

3. All comprehensiveness

Every individual and every association of the individual is subject to the sovereignty of the state. However rich or powerful association or group may be, it cannot resist or disobey the sovereign authority.

4. Inalienability

Sovereignty is the life and soul of the state and it cannot be alienated without destroying the state itself.

5. Unity and Everlasting

The spirit of sovereignty lies in its unity. Sovereignty is not bound by time and lasts until the state lasts.

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